



(Don't Write anything in this Area)

Section AWrite notes on the following in **150** words**10*5=50**Linguistic relativity principle

Linguistic Relativity principle was proposed by Edward Sapir and Benjamin Lee Whorf in their Sapir-Whorf hypothesis.

The principle suggests that language shapes our world view and determines how we make sense of the world around us. In other words, our perception of reality is relative to the language we speak.

→ It further suggests that language is a force in itself and coerces our thought which in turn shapes our cultures.

→ Ex I: Benjamin Lee Whorf compared Hopi and English language. He found

that English has discreteness in terms of time and space which is not so in Hopi. As a result, the Hopi world view is different because of their language. They tend to perceive things happening in present without distinct past or future.

→ Ex 2: Alexander Goira compared English, Hebrew and Finnish language and found that Hebrew had most gender emphasis and Finnish had least. As a result, Hebrew speaking child developed gender identity earliest and Finnish speaker at last.

The principle has been criticised for being too rigid in giving importance to language but despite that it shows the importance of language in influencing human mind.